If you're not sure where to start but want to put an executive dashboard together, here are some metrics that I've found leadership teams typically care about regardless of strategy:

- ***Number of releases/features per release*** —The frequency and volume with which you get changes out that your consumers respond well to show how engaged you are with them through your software products.
- ***Consumer-facing quality rating over time*** —This is the one metric that everyone in the organization should care about. From an executive level this tells you if everything is moving in the right direction.
- ***Development cost*** —Knowing how much you're spending on development is something anyone who controls a budget cares about. When you couple this with consumer engagement and satisfaction, it can help everyone understand the value they're getting from their investment.

Let's take an example of a native mobile app. The consumer-facing quality rating comes from the app store—iTunes for iOS apps and Google Play for Android apps. The rating is pretty simple; consumers give the app zero to five stars based on how much they like it, and the rating is published through the store. A quality check on this number could be the crash percentage for the version of the app released.

The development cost is most easily calculated by adding up the hours of the team that worked on the project. Devices, equipment, and support are usually included in overhead costs.

For mobile apps it's usually easiest to focus on a single feature at a time. In our example each release is tied to a single headline feature that's published with the metrics.

For the executive team it's best to get all the data in a single place so they can see the whole picture at a glance. In the example graph shown in figure 9.12 we use a bubble series chart to show all of these metrics at once. There's a bubble for each release on an axis, sized by the cost in total hours for the release. The x-axis represents crash rate and the y-axis represents the star rating.